

Vertigo

[> Chair's Report](#) [> Section News](#) [> Notices](#) [> Photo Comp Winners](#) [> Coming Trips, Courses, Events](#) [> Trip Reports](#) [> Section Contacts](#)
[> Our Club On A Page](#)

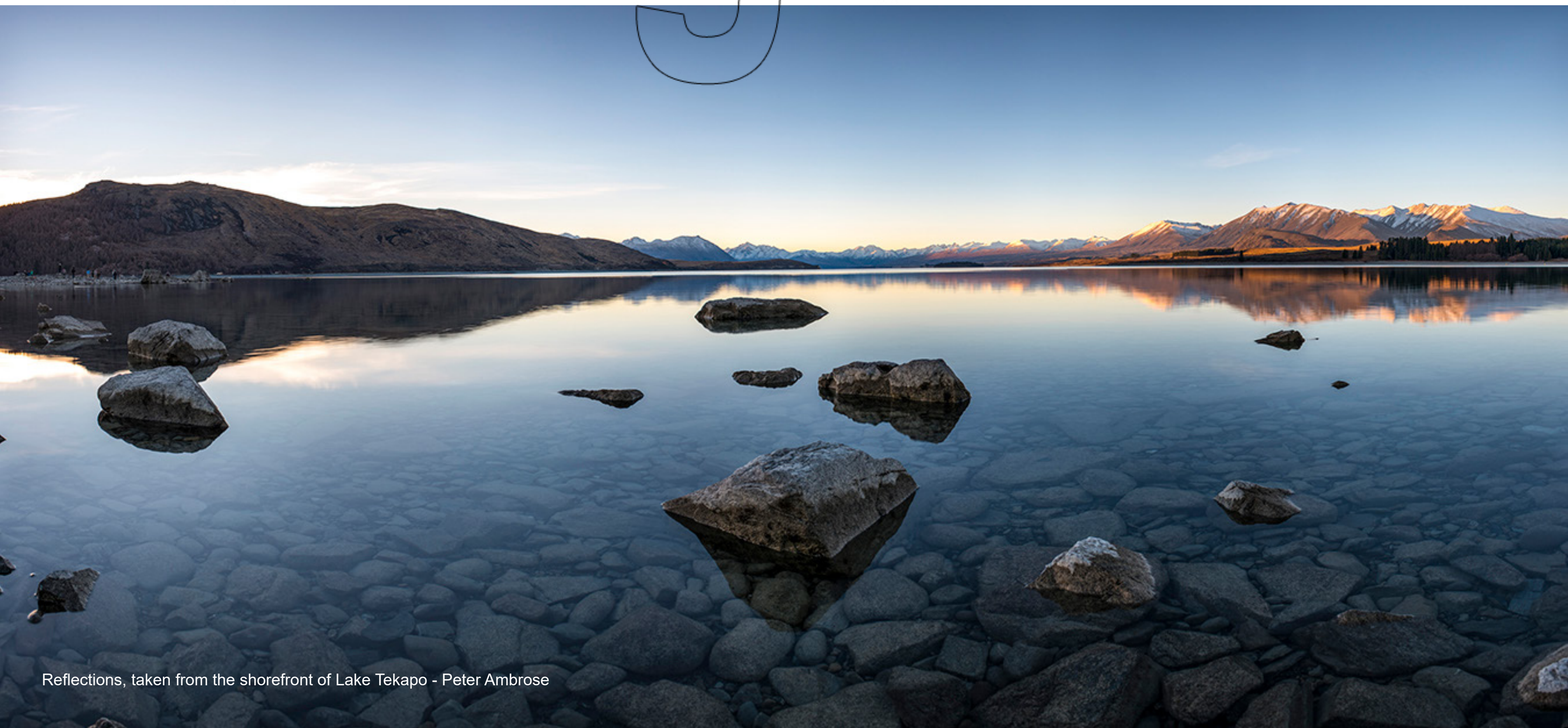
No 810 September 2017



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB

Wellington Section Monthly Bulletin

www.facebook.com/nzacwellington Twitter [@NZACWellington](https://twitter.com/NZACWellington)



Reflections, taken from the shorefront of Lake Tekapo - Peter Ambrose

Chair's Report

September 2017

As you can see we have had a change of face for Vertigo. After three years as Editor, Carolyn has passed the baton on to Peter Laurenson. Carolyn has done an awesome job, leaving Peter a hard act to follow, but I'm also sure he will continue to provide you with a quality and engaging publication. Let us know if you like it or not, or if you have any suggestions to improve Vertigo.

I'm writing this as I sit in the lodge at Tukino looking out the window at what may well be the last of the ski season's snow. Increasingly, backcountry skiing would appear to be a more reliable investment if you want to get some decent runs in.

On the weekend of the 30th and 1st (in two weeks time) we will be running our post snowcraft course trip which is open to all members. This is an instructor led trip. It's not a course. Having instructors as the trip leaders provides an opportunity for trip participants to practice their skills in more realistic conditions. It will be a grade 1 trip based out of the NZAC lodge at Delta Corner. The cost of the trip, which includes two nights accommodation, is \$60.00. Alex Waterford is organising the trip so please contact him for further information.

We will be showing this year's Reel Rock in November. Tickets will be on sale shortly. If you like the Banff films but want to see more climbing, Reel Rock is climbing films on steroids. More information will be sent out to you by email and on our section facebook page.

And finally: I've been studying Quantum Physics lately. It explains a lot of things and is very interesting but it doesn't explain and is still not as interesting to me as Climbing.

If you have any comments on what you like or don't like send an email to wellington@alpineclub.org.nz or tweet us [@NZACWellington](https://twitter.com/NZACWellington).

Simon

From the incoming Editor

Firstly, I add my vote of thanks to Caro for all her dedicated work on Vertigo.

With our hand over, I thought it was timely to take a fresh look at Vertigo and make some changes to better use our solely online channel now - hence the landscape/screen oriented format. Also note the page quicklinks at the base of each page - they let you go straight to the page you want rather than having to scroll back and forth all the time.

I hope you like it. Feedback either way is welcomed at occasionalclimber@gmail.com. This is also where to send trip reports and any other items for future Vertigos.

Peter

Simon Williamson
Chair: NZAC Wellington

Section News

September Section night



When From 6pm, Wednesday 27th September
Where The Third Eye, 30 Arthur St, Te Aro, Wellington
Entry Members \$5, Non-members \$10

This presentation and Q&A are for you if:

- Until now you've relied on auto or programme settings on your camera, but you're ready to invest more headspace into your photography.
- You want to know more about what's really possible with outdoor photography.

Presented by Peter Laurenson, an NZAC member since 2002 and Wellington Section annual photo competition judge for the past three years.

For his photography credentials visit www.occasionalclimber.co.nz



October Section night

John Palmer, incoming NZAC President, will share his thoughts about "RIP New Zealand climbing. Died: 2017. Cause of death: No access"

Section News

Gear Hire

Don't forget the Section has gear for hire: avalanche transceivers, ice axes, shovels, stakes, hammers, helmets, crampons, probes, PLBs, ice hammers (entry level).

To hire gear please fill in the form [here](#).

Each item costs \$5 per week with the exception of PLBs – PLBs are free but require a deposit of \$50 refundable on return.

A little bit of advance notice would be appreciated as gear often needs to be retrieved from the gear store in Lower Hutt. Gear collections and drop-offs are usually available in the city during the working day or at section night.

Accommodation on Mt Ruapehu

Our snowcraft courses for the past few years have been run out of the Manawatu Tramping and Skiing Club lodge on Whakapapa. We're always made to feel welcome and the lodge is well situated a short walk from the top of the Bruce Road. Membership to the club is extremely reasonable - \$35 per year or \$50 for a family membership. Members stay at the lodge for \$36 a night including food. If you're looking for somewhere to base yourself for your winter pursuits or rock-climbing over the summer months go to www.mtsc.org.nz/joining.php to find out more about joining the club.



Heading to Mt Cupola, Nelson Lakes

Notices

Can you identify them?

National Office has been asked for help to ID the guys in these pictures. Find out more [here](#).



NZAC Volunteer of the Year Award

Nominations are open for the 2017 NZAC Volunteer of the Year Award – nominations must be received by Monday 3 October 2017. Individuals and Sections can nominate an NZAC volunteer that they think has done great work over the last year. Please contact your Section Committee with members you would like them to nominate and complete the nomination form. The VOTY is announced at the NZAC AGM and Veteran Member, Edgar Glass' (1930-2008) ice-axe is presented as part of the special award. Read [more](#).



Youth Ski Mountaineering Scholarship

Young alpinists looking to embark on a ski mountaineering expedition - apply now for the Splitfest Backcountry Festival Youth Ski Mountaineering Scholarship - Sponsored by NZAC. Applications close 30 September 2017. Read [more](#).

UIAA ice climbing season

The provisional calendar for the 2018 UIAA Ice Climbing season is now in place. Read [more](#).

2017 Mountain Protection Award

The 2017 Mountain Protection Award has just announced 26 projects from 15 countries who have applied - to see what other countries are doing read [more](#).

Historic ascent of Shispare northeast face

Kazuya Hiraide and Kenro Nakajima successfully summited the 7611m peak of Shispare, Pakistan, via a new route of the northeast face at 14:30 on 22 August. This is considered to be the first ascent of the northeast face of Shispare and becomes one of the stand-out mountaineering achievements of the year. Read [more](#).

High Alpine Skills Courses

Mostly full, however still applications for waitlist. Read [more](#).

NZAC Summer Photography workshop

Aimed at beginner-intermediate photographers wanting to improve their outdoor photography skills. Read [more](#).

NZRA Awards

Read [more](#).

Photo Comp 2017 Results

Our annual photo competition was concluded at our August Section night, when Peter Laurenson, a judge for the competition for the past three years, took those present through his thoughts about each entry and announced the seven category winners. The table shows how our competition has shaped up over the past three years.

Entries by category	2015	2016	Change	2017	Change
Alpine General	28	28	0%	28	0%
Alpine Activity	13	19	46%	18	-5%
Alpine Nature	12	19	58%	22	16%
Rock Climbing	11	8	-27%	7	-13%
Mountain Culture	5	11	120%	21	91%
Humour	4	12	200%	6	-50%
Kids	13	11	-15%	5	-55%
	86	108	26%	107	-1%

The Overall Winner was chosen from the seven category winning entries by vote from those in the audience. Congratulations to the winners. Here and next page are the seven category winning entries with judge’s comments.



Rock Climbing: Iain Burgon
Leading the first pitch of Indian summer an awesome route on the Remarkables East face

A different perspective than normally seen - not sure how the climber took this one. It shows clearly the technical gear placement and system, the verticality. Quite nicely exposed. What put this image very slightly ahead of the others in this category is that it's taken by the climber himself. Great to see this kind of mountaineering shot.



Mountain Culture: Iain Burgon
Three days of gales and white out at Pioneer hut 2378m

A brilliant image capturing downtime in an alpine hut. The choice of black and white gives it a documentary quality which also works with heavier use of contrast, which is what this photographer seems to prefer. Great depth of field and choice of panoramic format, so you can browse around looking at all the different characters and what they're doing. Reading, writing in a diary, doing cooking - all classic hut activities. A great shot!



Alpine Activity: Derek Cheng

Pillipow focuses his eyes on the next strike, as delicate snow particles drift around him. Wicked Wanda, WI5, Ghost River Wilderness Area, Canada

Excellent up close and personal action. The angle accentuates the gradient and vertical position. The facial expression and single planted axe convey required care. Snow particles add depth, movement and drama. Very nice composition balanced around the cross configuration, not the climber. A really great alpine activity image.



Humour: Derek Cheng

Giant girlfriend and tiny boyfriend. Bonnieville Salt Flats

Not an alpine shot, but nicely composed and exposed. Notably it's an image that is humorous, with or without it's caption - the coy stance and expression on the girl's face sets it apart from the other entries in this category.



Kids: Felix Williamson

Boys in the hood, Rocky Lookout

A very good exposure; and a good idea - the team as one looking purposefully at something. Enough to take the prize in this category.



Alpine Nature: Katja Riedel

Serrated edge of an iceberg, Paradise Bay, Antarctica

A beautifully exposed, singleminded image. Well composed and cropped to accentuate the many ice ridges. I can see it somewhere on the wall - nature's art.



Alpine General and Overall Winner: Peter Ambrose

Reflections, taken from the shorefront of Lake Tekapo

A really beautiful, well balanced panorama, tastefully processed with great shadow detail in the foreground and delicate warm light in the background. Nice application of rule of thirds. I can feel the tranquility.

Coming Trips, Courses, Events

All our planned South Island trips come with the added bonus that rental vehicle costs for Wellington Section members are covered by the Section.

If you're uncertain about the skill level required with any of the trips, would like to register your interest or to find out more, email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Also, please contact us if you're keen to run a trip yourself – the Committee can help with advertising and logistics.

When	Where
27 September	September section night at the Third Eye: Presentation and Q&A on outdoor photography - Peter Laurenson
29 September - 1 October	Post Snow Craft trip - led by Alex Waterworth. To secure a place complete the application form here . Cost \$60. Details >
5 October	MOUNTAIN - in cinemas October 5. Wellington - Roxy More details here .
6-8 October	North Island Ski Touring Meet, Tukino Ski Field, Mt Ruapehu. More details here
Labour Weekend, 19-23 October	Mt Travers (Nelson Lakes) – led by Simon Williamson
Labour Weekend, 21-23 October	Paynes Ford rock climbing – led by Eric Duggan
November	Aspiring Take 2, details coming soon
November	Reel Rock, details coming soon

Section trip, Mount Wakefield

Outdoor Training NZ Courses

OTNZ Wellington is running training courses as follows:

Navigation (6 and 11 November)

In depth course to teach skills and knowledge to enable safe navigation both in the bush and above the bushline.

River Safety (3 December)

Course covers understanding river dynamics and hazards, how to evaluate sites for safe crossing, methods of crossing, preparing clothing and equipment for a crossing, managing a group crossing, pack floating and how to self-rescue if swept away.

More information on these courses and how to book your place can be found at www.outdoortraining.nz/courses/courses.php.

Details - Post Snow Craft Trip

Self arrange transport to Whakapapa Ski field on Friday 29/10/2017. Be at the top of the Bruce Road no later than 9:00pm. An instructor will lead groups up to the Hut which is 60-90 mins walk and will require some alpine skill.

Accommodation is at NZAC Ruapehu Hut on Friday and Saturday nights, if you have not stayed there before please have a look on the NZAC website so you know what to expect facilities wise, and have an idea of where you will be heading before you arrive.

The weekend will be self catered so you will be in charge of feeding yourselves. You will also need to be responsible for any personal gear this includes safety equipment, sleeping, clothing ect. If you have any questions about gear please call or email me.

Safety equipment is a mandatory requirement for this trip you will need to have Avalanche transceiver, shovel, probe, helmet, ice axe and crampons. These can be hired from the Section at a flat rate of \$20, if you need to borrow gear let me know asap.

What we do will depend heavily on the weather and make up of the group, we will have a number of instructors so we have the scope to break into two groups and mix things up.

We will not be teaching rope skills on this trip but if you have the proven experience or have recently learned these skills on one of our courses and want to practice we may be able to rope up and do a few pitches. This will depend firstly on the conditions and also on you bringing the appropriate gear and protection. Again if you need to borrow gear let me know.

There is no set route at this point but the aim is to get up onto the summit peaks and ridges in some form. There are a number of possibilities, all of which are very achievable from the Hut, so we will try to stay flexible.

We will aim to walk out early Sunday afternoon.

I will be holding logistics evenings on 25th, 26th and 27th in Wellington to meet you all, discuss the trip in a bit more detail, organise transport plans and distribute gear. It is important that you attend one of these!

Trip Reports

Crater country

Words and photographs Peter Laurenson

The moonless, crystal-clear sky offered the most vivid view of the Milky Way I'd ever seen. That's saying something – I've enjoyed that spectacle many times from some other fabulous locations. I couldn't seem to get my violent shivering under control though. Up there at just over 1,800 metres in a dip between Tongariro's summit and the outer rim of North Crater it was well below freezing, so that wasn't a surprise, but why was I hyperventilating? Sealed in my bivy bag, fully clothed except for my boots, with delicate pieces of my condensed and then frozen breath dropping on my face, I felt no fear. So my rapid breathing was a physical rather than emotionally driven response to my situation. But having endured it for three hours, the knowledge that I had another nine to go until dawn didn't fill me with joy.



Sunset, with Tongariro at right

My two young Spanish companions, Juan and Raoul, lay shivering a few metres away in my slightly less frigid two man tent. Raoul had been a last minute addition to our party, so perhaps Juan felt a twinge of guilt that I was outside. He offered me his little travel pillow, which I gratefully accepted. In so doing I exposed my face and almost immediately my breathing settled down. Ah ha, maybe I'm susceptible to mild claustrophobia. That could explain my dislike of crowds and shopping malls.

Eventually the first hint of dawn arrived and I extracted myself, somewhat stiffly, from my cocoon. From our camp we had the view point options of Tongariro's summit (1,967m) or the slightly lower rim (1,909m) of North Crater. Having been up Tongariro several times I chose the latter. It was a relief to feel the warmth of uphill movement as I made a beeline for North Crater's outer rim 100 metres above. My crampon spikes squeaked as they bit effortlessly into the firm snow. At last, for the first time this winter, I was blessed with perfect alpine conditions.

Dawn in the mountains – this is what I had primarily come for and Mother Nature didn't disappoint. Taking in a new perspective from the southern rim of North Crater, I took photo after photo as the drama unfolded, also enjoying the gradual warmth of the new day's first light.



The dawn view north from the south rim of North Crater

Later, back down near camp in the midst of a number two nature call a mischievous breeze suddenly blew down from the north, snatching my toilet paper roll from my hand. In my compromised squat I watched in dismay as it bounced and unrolled off down the slope. Luckily I still had the unrolled end in my grasp and, to my surprise, the eight or so metre strand didn't snap. Like a rope I coiled it back in, stuffed most of it into my coat and completed my delicate task. Not long after, just as we'd set the main tent igloo free from its fly that breeze snuck through again and nearly carried the tent in the same direction as my toilet roll. Quick reactions just saved the day.



Our tent and bivy site, with a partly disassembled escaping tent right

For me, the other motivation for this trip was to tread new ground on that most famous of places, Tongariro National Park. The estimate for 2016/17 was 130,000 walkers on the Tongariro Crossing – an average of 356 for every day of the year, although apparently the peak in summer reaches 2,000. In a single day! But I knew it's still not difficult to dodge the crowds. Visiting in winter cuts the numbers down dramatically, although even then we encountered several guided groups when our route intersected the trampled trail of the main crossing. But, in good conditions, there are almost unlimited options on this relatively easy terrain to avoid the madding crowd.

Our route left the main trail down at Mangatepopo Hut (1,190m) the afternoon before, crossing the stream and following the ridge all the way to Tongariro's rime encrusted summit (1,967m). I'd been this way only a week before, but things had changed – for one the snowline had receded from about 1,250m to 1,650m. On my last visit we couldn't see much, but now we were trudging in to a period of the most settled weather in weeks.

With no snow I noted this time how, even here, a much more discernible path has been worn. We'd reached the summit a little before sunset, leaving enough time to find a suitably sheltered camp site, set up camp and heat water for dinner.



On the first evening on top of Tongariro

Camping up on top put us in position to enjoy what MetService had accurately predicted would be a primo, blue bird day in what really is a crater-pocked landscape. Our route skirted around North Crater, across a large flat plateau. From there we dropped 100 metres on what proved to be the steepest section of the day, requiring some front pointing, to the northern end of the main crossing trail above Ketetahi. Then we climbed again, eastward to the top of Rotopaunga (1,856m) and gazed out over Lakes Rotoaira and Taupo to the north. In the foreground lay Te Mari (1,739m), the site of Tongariro's most recent eruption on 6th August 2012, which sent an ash cloud five miles into the sky. For us, while some white geothermal steam lazily twisted its way skyward, there were virtually no clouds to be seen.

From Rotopaunga we dropped again, this time skirting the eastern edge of Blue Lake, which is another water-filled and, in winter, frozen crater. At its southern end is an un-named 1,850 metre highpoint. Perfectly located to enjoy lunch, we took in virtually our entire route, with spectacular close views of some intimidating vertical cliffs, Central Crater directly below and Red Crater just to the south. In warm sunshine and not a breath of wind, our enjoyment was further enhanced, as we watched a straggly line of guided ants plodding along the main route below. Both complete mountaineering novices, Juan and Raoul realised then just what a special kiwi outdoor experience they were enjoying, telling me it was the most impressive of their international backpacker travels so far.



Mount Taranaki at sunset from the carpark

Descent from our lunchtime high point saw us also back to the main route, which we would follow southward back to our cars. As we cramponed along, we met a couple of young guys in sandals, parkas and not much else. Granted, the conditions were perfect, but the irresponsible idiocy of their clothing had me shaking my head. Ignorance? Arrogance? Disrespect? Or a combination of all three!

Even on a trail bereft of snow due to the heavy traffic it receives, it was still a 200 metre vertical slog up to the top of Red Crater's rim from the southern edge of Central Crater.

Unlike in summer, when the two little Emerald Lakes can't be missed on this section of the trail, they were frozen and nowhere to be seen. Even so, each high point rewarded us with yet another magnificent panoramic perspective of the otherworldly volcanic landscape. After all, the Tongariro Crossing is famous for good reason. Our own tour of the Tongariro craters had certainly been memorable.

For more images and a route map - www.occasionalclimber.co.nz



Section Contacts

Powered by volunteers

We're always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. A lot goes on to keep our club going, virtually all powered by volunteers. On the back page is our "Club on a page" summary. It gives an at a glance description of all the things we do, how and why. Feel free to print a copy and pass it on to anyone who might be interested in becoming a member or volunteer. And if you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Position	Name	Contact
Chair person	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
Co Chair	Eric Duggan	021 350 161
Secretary	Carolyn Ellis	021 574 287
Treasurer	Vacant	
Section nights, Vertigo	Peter Laurenson	021 446 725
Patron	John Nankervis	
Social media, Projects	Elisha Watson	
Projects	Matt Pemberton	
Projects	Sandy Britain	
Library, Projects	Alex Waterworth	
Rock drill overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 555 5893

www.facebook.com/nzacwellington

Twitter @NZACWellington



Shed 6 Queens Wharf
Wellingtons Waterfront
Ph 04 4998898 Fax 04 4998896
wn@fergskayaks.co.nz
www.fergskayaks.co.nz

Open 7 Days

Largest Real Rock Indoor Rock Wall – Kayaking – Inline Skates - Retail - Rental

Alpine Club members can climb any time for \$12
Monday nights show your Alpine Club card and climb for \$10

New routes every week*

\$1000 worth of new holds in Jan/Feb 2012
New pad in "Da Cave" allowing safe aggressive bouldering

Creating happiness through better climbing

* to be precise, this is just an average but we do aim for new routes every single week.

HangDog Rock Climbing Adventures
453 Hutt Rd
Lower Hutt
(04) 589 9181
info@hangdog.co.nz

www.hangdog.co.nz

i climb .co.nz

Simond alpine equipment direct from the importer

Ocelot
\$115

MXC 820
\$230

Makalu
\$255

Caiman
\$230

all crampons include anti-balling plates and crampon bag

i climb .co.nz



For quick access to our Section's page on the NZAC website, click or scan this QR code

Our club on a page



WHAT WE DO

FOR MEMBERS

Facilities

- * Huts
- * Gear
- * Library
- * Discounts

Training

- * Level 1- 3 winter skills
- * Summer rock
- * Instructors

Climbing trips

- * Section
- * National
- * International

FOR MEMBERS AND WIDER PUBLIC

Publications

- * Website
- * Social media
- * Vertigo
- * Guide books

Events

- * Banff mountain film festival
- * Reel Rock
- * Photo comp

Networking

- * Section nights
- * Conferences and meetings
- * Lobbying

HOW WE DO IT

Organise, encourage, support, enable

Inform, entertain, promote

OUR RESOURCES

Volunteer time and capabilities, income from events and gear hire, national office support, sponsorship

WHY WE DO IT

Connecting & developing more climbing & mountaineering people, knowledge, skills & experience, thereby ...

... building lifelong friendships

... protecting and improving access to alpine places

... sustaining and growing climbing and mountaineering achievement

... enhancing alpine safety

... building appreciation, enjoyment and protection of alpine places

Image and diagram Peter Laurensen www.occasionalclimber.co.nz